

Pear Therapeutics submits latest digital therapeutic, insomnia and depression treatment

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CBT-based treatment targets insomnia and depression



Patients with insomnia and depression could soon be prescribed Somryst, a 'digital therapeutic' to treat their conditions – potentially in place of medicines.

Pear Therapeutics is a pioneer of so-called digital therapeutics, having gained the first ever such approval from the FDA in 2017, for its treatment for patients with Substance Use Disorder (SUD).

It then followed this up with the approval in December 2018, of reSET-O, for the treatment of Opioid Use Disorder, which it co-markets with [Novartis subsidiary Sandoz](#).

Its Prescription Digital Therapeutics (PDTs) are app-based programmes which use cognitive behavioural therapy (CBT) to help patients with their conditions.

The company yesterday announced that it had filed Somryst with the FDA, and is the first product filed via a new designated Software Pre-certification Pilot Program, aimed at making the approval process clearer and faster for the emerging field.

In the case of the new insomnia and depression therapeutic, CBT is provided in conjunction with a sleep restriction algorithm.

Like a drug filing with the FDA, Pear Therapeutics is backing up its submission with substantial clinical data, its two randomised controlled clinical trials involving more than 1,400 patients.

Depression is a commonly co-occurring condition with insomnia, and around 1,100 of those involved in the trial had diagnosed depression. In the nine week study, the treatment arm received the investigational PDT, and the comparator arm received an attention-matched digital placebo along with usual care. Results were measured at baseline, at nine weeks, and post-treatment at six months, 12 months, and 18 months.

At the end of a 9-week treatment course adults randomised to the investigational PDT showed a reduction in mean Insomnia Severity Index (ISI) score to 7.27, from baseline of mean 15.92, while the control patients of showed a reduction in ISI score to a mean of 13.17, from a baseline of mean 16.23 (LS Mean Differences of -5.90, (95% CI, -6.68, -5.11); $p < 0.0001$).

Patients using Somryst also saw a reduction in depression severity, as measured by the Patient Health Questionnaire 9 (PHQ9), to a mean score of 3.78, from a baseline mean of 8.03, while control patients showed reduction to a mean PHQ9 score of 6.20, from a mean of

失眠症和抑郁症患者可能很快就会被处方 Somryst，这是一种治疗他们疾病的“数字疗法”——可能代替药物。Pear Therapeutics 是所谓数字疗法的先驱，于 2017 年首次获得 FDA 的此类批准，用于治疗物质使用障碍 (SUD) 患者。随后，该公司于 2018 年 12 月批准 reSET-O 用于治疗阿片类药物使用障碍，并与诺华子公司 Sandoz 共同销售。其处方数字治疗 (PDTs) 是基于 app 的项目，使用认知行为疗法 (CBT) 帮助患者缓解病情。该公司昨日宣布，已向 FDA 提交了 Somryst 申请，并且是首个通过新指定的软件预认证试点项目提交申请的产品，旨在使审批流程更加清晰和快速地将应用于新兴领域。在新的失眠和抑郁症治疗的情况下，CBT 与睡眠限制算法一起提供。就像向 FDA 提交药品申请一样，Pear Therapeutics 也在用大量的临床数据来支持其申请，这两项随机对照临床试验涉及 1400 多名患者。抑郁症通常与失眠症并存，参与试验的患者中约有 1100 人被诊断为抑郁症。在为期 9 周的研究中，治疗组接受研究性 PDT 治疗，对照组接受注意力匹配的数字安慰剂和常规治疗。在基线、9 周时以及治疗后 6 个月、12 个月和 18 个月时测量结果。在 9 周疗程结束时，随机接受研究性 PDT 的成人显示平均失眠严重指数 (ISI) 评分从基线均值 15.92 降至 7.27，而对照患者显示 ISI 评分从基线均值 16.23 降至 13.17 (LS 均值差异为 -5.90, (95%CI, -6.68, -5.11)。 $p < 0.0001$)。使用 Somryst 的患者还观察到抑郁严重程度 (通过患者健康问卷 9 (PHQ9) 测量) 从基线平均值 8.03 降至平均评分 3.78，而对照患者显示从基线平均值 7.84 降至平均 PHQ9 评分 6.20 (LS 均值差异 -2.42, (95%CI, -3.01, -1.83)。 $p < 0.0001$)。一个大问题当然是该疗法的益处会有多持久。研究发现，在 9 周治疗结束时，大多数使用 PDT 治疗的患者不再符合失眠或抑郁的标准，该公司表示，在最初 9 周治疗疗程后，临床改善“持续至 18 个月”。美国的支付者会很感兴趣，看看这种治疗是否能持续超过 18 个月，以及这种治疗是否比传统的安眠药和抑郁症药物更经济。认知行为治疗失眠 (CBTi) 是指南推荐的慢性失眠患者的一线治疗，这一事实应该会促进公司从临床医生那里获得认可。然而，大多数患者无法接受或获得治疗——获批的数字 app 可以对其进行改造。“每 3 个成年人中就有 1 个在一周内出现失眠症状，超过 3000 万成年人患有慢性失眠。慢性失眠会对生活质量产生影响，并使人们长期处于抑郁、高血压甚至心脏病发作的危险之中。查尔斯 M. 莫林博士，魁北克市拉瓦尔大学睡眠研究中心主任，心理学教授。“大多数成人失眠症患者接受短期使用或与失眠症作斗争的药物，而没有接受有效、持久的治疗。通过临床医生的适当临床监督和管理，Somryst 可促进患者接受 CBTi 治疗。”Pear Therapeutics 说，这项研究还显示了焦虑症状的改善 (通过一般焦虑障碍 7 项 (GAD-7) 量表测量)，治疗组平均值为 3.16，而对照组平均值为 4.99，(LS 均值差异 -1.83, (95%CI, -2.41, -1.25)。 $p < 0.0001$) 和自杀意念 (通过精神症状频率量表测量)，治疗组平均值为 0.51，对照组平均值为 0.80 (LS 均值差异 -0.29, (95%CI, -0.53, -0.06), $p = 0.0147$) 4。研究结果发表在《柳叶刀精神病学》上。Pear Therapeutics 并不是该领域唯一活跃的公司：今年 1 月，大家宣布与 Click Therapeutics 达成交易，开发一款类似的基于 CBT 的 app，用于治疗重度抑郁症 (MMD)

A big question is of course how long-lasting the benefits of the therapy will be. The study found that the majority of patients using the PDT treatment no longer met criteria for insomnia or depression at the end of the 9-week treatment, and the company says clinical improvements “persisted to 18 months” following the initial 9-week treatment course.

US payers will be interested to see if benefits can last longer than this 18 month period – and indeed if the therapy is a cost effective alternative to conventional sleeping pills and depression medication. The company should see its acceptance from clinicians boosted by the fact that cognitive behavioural therapy for insomnia (CBTi) is the guideline recommended first-line treatment for people with chronic insomnia. However most patients do not receive or have access to the therapy – something which an approved digital app could transform.

“One in three adults suffer from symptoms of insomnia in a given week and more than 30 million adults have chronic insomnia. Chronic insomnia can have an impact on quality of life – and can put people at risk long-term for depression, hypertension, and even heart attack,” said Dr. Charles M. Morin, PhD, professor of psychology, director Sleep Research Centre at Université Laval in Quebec City.

“Most adults with insomnia receive medication intended for short-term use or struggle with insomnia without receiving effective, lasting treatment. Somryst could facilitate patient access to CBTi treatment with appropriate clinical oversight and management from clinicians.”

Pear Therapeutics says the study also showed improvements in anxiety symptoms (as measured by the General Anxiety Disorder 7-item (GAD-7) scale), with a treatment arm mean of 3.16 compared to Control arm mean of 4.99, (LS Mean Differences -1.83, (95% CI, -2.41, -1.25); $p < 0.0001$), and suicidal ideation (as measured by the Psychiatric Symptom Frequency Scale), with a treatment arm mean of 0.51 compared to control arm mean of 0.80, (LS Mean Differences -0.29, (95% CI, -0.53, -0.06), $p = 0.0147$). Results of the study were published in Lancet Psychiatry.

Pear Therapeutics isn't the only company active in the field: in January this year, Otsuka announced a deal with Click Therapeutics to develop a similar CBT-based app for the treatment of major depressive disorder (MMD).

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